

## newyears20245bigfranky

First up, it was New Year's Eve, 2024 in Amsterdam, the Netherlands. All went well and it's a very special time in North Holland, which is one of the provinces in the Netherlands where Amsterdam is located. I was in Amsterdam for New Year's Eve and caught up with one of the famous locals.

Travel Radio Australia, it's New Year's Eve in Amsterdam and I'm in a house, a lovely house in the Jordaan with a very famous person from Amsterdam, Big Frankie. Now, Big Frankie is one of the top music guys here in Amsterdam. He shows people around who come here, the big music stars.

Frankie is a veteran of New Year's Eve parties in Amsterdam. Frankie, welcome to the programme. Yeah, welcome everybody.

And hello to all of our listeners in Australia and around the world, yes. Now, Frankie, the build-up to New Year's Eve is quite extensive in the Netherlands. Of course, we start off with the Sinterklaas party and when does that happen? It's the 5th of December, Sinterklaas.

Yeah, it's a real Dutch thing, you know, for the children and parties. It's not like Christmas, it's like a tradition of Holland. The Christmas Day is not as big as Sinterklaas, right? Yes, that's right.

Sinterklaas is typical Dutch, you know. The Christmas party is different, but also good for children, presents under the tree, like everywhere in the world, you know. But it's a fun time and it's a build-up to the special night tonight, you know, New Year's night.

And there will be many, many parties all over the city in Amsterdam with live music and, you know, it's amazing every year, it's great. A lot of fireworks and, yeah, I feel a bit sorry for the animals always, that's my opinion. It's a new start and hopefully a new beginning and a better world in the next year without all these wars and all these victims, especially for the children, because I heard one of the seven children live in a war zone this year, you know, so that's really sad and terrible to hear.

So, best wishes and hopefully a better world in 2025. Yes, and the New Year's Eve here, when people think of fireworks, like in Sydney or whatever, they only go on for about 20 minutes. And the fireworks here start really early and it's really massive, isn't it? Yeah, it's really massive, especially in the Chinese area and the red light.

But also there are build-ups from trees and there will be on tomorrow, actually, and it will be a big, big fire, you know, especially in the Hague and at the beaches. We only have to take care because it's a windy night, so there are some regulations for the fires because a few years ago it was a big problem because the wind took the fire to the houses behind the beaches. So hopefully everything goes well and I hope everybody have a great New Year's Eve and I wish all the listeners the best wishes for 2025 from Amsterdam.

Big Frankie. Thank you, Frankie, for being part of the programme and our New Year's Eve Travel Radio Australia special. Can you say hello to everyone? Oh, there's fireworks already starting in the background.

Can you say hello in Dutch to all of our friends in Australia? Yeah, here is Big Frankie at Amsterdam. You're done. I'd like to say hello to all of our friends in the New Year, in 2005 and in the winter.

And I hope everybody will be able to hear from all of our friends in the new year. And thank you to all of our friends in the new year. And thank you to Amsterdam.

Oi!